

SUPERIOR COURT OF CALIFORNIA, CONTRA COSTA COUNTY
MARTINEZ, CA
DEPARTMENT 16
JUDICIAL OFFICER: BENJAMIN T REYES II
HEARING DATE: 06/03/2026

**INSTRUCTIONS FOR CONTESTING TENTATIVE RULINGS
IN DEPARTMENT 16**

The tentative ruling will become the ruling of the Court unless by 4:00 P.M. of the Court day preceding the hearing, notice is given of an intent to argue the matter. Counsel or self-represented parties must email Department 16 (Dept16@contracosta.courts.ca.gov) to request argument and **must specify, in detail, what provision(s) of the tentative ruling they intend to argue and why.** Counsel or self-represented parties requesting argument must advise all other counsel and self-represented parties by no later than 4:00 P.M. of their decision to argue, and of the issues to be argued. Failure to timely advise the Court and counsel or self-represented parties will preclude any party from arguing the matter. (Pursuant to Local Rule 3.43(2).)

The prevailing party must prepare and e-file a proposed order after hearing in accordance with CRC 3.1312. The order must include appearances. If the tentative ruling becomes the Court's ruling, a copy of the Court's tentative ruling **must be attached to the proposed order** when submitted to the Court for issuance of the order.

ALL APPEARANCES TO ARGUE WILL BE IN PERSON OR BY ZOOM, PROVIDED THAT PROPER NOTIFICATION IS RECEIVED BY THE DEPARTMENT AS PER ABOVE.

Zoom link-

<https://www.zoomgov.com/j/1619504895?pwd=NOV1N3JFRnJ0TEVoSDNrTGRzakF3UT09>

ID: 161 950 489

Password: 812674

Courtroom Clerk's Session

1. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C23-00085

CASE NAME: LAURA BEGIN VS. SAN RAMON VALLEY FIRE PROTECTION DISTRICT

*TRIAL SETTING CONFERENCE TO TRAIL SUMMARY JUDGMENT ALREADY ON CALENDAR

FILED BY:

TENTATIVE RULING:

This Case Management Conference / Trial Setting Conference (CMC) trails the hearing on Line 5. The Parties are ordered to appear for a TSC, unless the tentative ruling is unopposed.

2. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C25-00261

CASE NAME: KIKI BROWS VS. RAMANUJAN GROUP LLC

*CASE MANAGEMENT CONFERENCE

FILED BY:

TENTATIVE RULING:

This Case Management Conference (CMC) trails the hearing on Line 12. Since Line 12 is unopposed,

this CMC is continued to August 25, 2026 at 8:30 a.m. The Parties shall file a further case management conference statement and are ordered to meet and confer to discuss Alternative Dispute Resolution. No appearance is required on June 3, 2026.

3. 8:31 AM CASE NUMBER: C25-00694
CASE NAME: ELIZABETH HILAMAN VS. MCDONALD'S USA, LLC
***FURTHER CASE MANAGEMENT CONFERENCE**

FILED BY:

TENTATIVE RULING:

This Case Management Conference (CMC) trails the hearing on Lines 14 and 15. This CMC is continued to trail the discovery motion scheduled for September 9, 2026 at 8:30 a.m. The Parties are ordered to meet and confer to discuss alternative dispute resolution.

4. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C25-02746
CASE NAME: CARTER HALLOCK VS. WENDY JARDINE
***CASE MANAGEMENT CONFERENCE**

FILED BY:

TENTATIVE RULING:

This Case Management Conference (CMC) trails the hearing on Lines 18 and 19. It is continued, along with those Lines, to June 10, 2026 at 9:00 a.m.

Law & Motion

5. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C23-00085
CASE NAME: LAURA BEGIN VS. SAN RAMON VALLEY FIRE PROTECTION DISTRICT
HEARING ON SUMMARY MOTION RE DEFENDANTS SAN RAMON VALLEY FIRE PROTECTION DISTRICT AND JOHN DUGGAN

FILED BY:

TENTATIVE RULING:

Before the Court is a motion for summary judgment, or in the alternative, summary adjudication of issues filed by defendants San Ramon Valley Fire District and John Duggan. For the reasons set forth, the motion for summary judgment is **denied**, and the motion for summary adjudication is also **denied**.

Background

Plaintiff Laura Begin was hired by defendant San Ramon Valley Fire District ("SRV Fire" or the "District") as the EMS Coordinator in September 2019. In November 2021, she was placed on a medical leave by her doctor. She extended her medical leave several times until March 2023, when she resigned her position.

In the operative second amended complaint ("2AC"), Plaintiff has sued the District on four causes of action under the California Fair Employment and Housing Act, Government Code section 12940, et seq. ("FEHA") for retaliation (1st C/A), harassment – hostile work environment (2nd C/A), failure to prevent discrimination and harassment (3rd C/A), and gender discrimination (4th C/A). She has also sued Chief John Duggan. The Court previously sustained the Duggan demurrer to the first cause of action without leave to amend. (12/13/2023 Min. Order.) Duggan remains a defendant in the second